

PROMPTING 101 CHEAT SHEET

A quick guide to writing effective prompts in ChatGPT. Use these tips to get better, faster, and more reliable results.

CORE PRINCIPLES

- **Be Specific** – Clearly state what you want (e.g., ‘Summarize this report into 3 key takeaways’).
- **Provide Context** – Add role or scenario (e.g., ‘Act as a project manager...’).
- **Break it Down** – Use step-by-step instructions for complex tasks.
- **Iterate** – Refine results by asking follow-up prompts (e.g., ‘Now make it more concise’).
- **Request Formats** – Ask for tables, bullet points, or outlines for clarity.

PROMPTING DO’S & DON’TS

DO’S

- ✓ Use role-based prompts (‘Act as a financial analyst’).
- ✓ Provide examples of the style or tone you want.
- ✓ Use iteration to improve drafts.

DON’TS

- ✗ Paste sensitive or confidential data.
- ✗ Expect perfect accuracy—always fact-check.
- ✗ Give vague instructions like ‘Write something about finance’.

EXAMPLE PROMPTS

- **Draft an email:** ‘Write a professional email to a vendor explaining a two-week delay in delivery, keeping the tone apologetic yet confident.’
- **Summarize content:** ‘Summarize this 10-page report into 3 bullet points focused on risks and recommendations.’
- **Create structured output:** ‘Compare Site A vs Site B in a table with columns for energy cost, water availability, and tax incentives.’
- **Brainstorm ideas:** ‘Suggest 5 creative ideas for improving safety engagement on construction sites.’

PRO TIPS

- Treat ChatGPT like a brainstorming partner, not a final authority.
- Use natural language—don’t overthink your prompt.
- Build on outputs with follow-up prompts for refinement.
- If you don’t like the first answer, rephrase and try again.